SSC CGL 2024 Tier-I question paper with answers

12 September 2024 · Shift 2

80 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 20 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://ssc.gov.in/api/attachment/uploads/masterData/AnswerKeys/Writeup_Final_Anwerkey_CGLE_2024_T1_191224.pdf

Compare your score: the official 2024 cut-off (Tier-I, all posts except JSO and SI Grade-II), out of 200

UR 153.19 **OBC** 146.26 **EWS** 142.02 **SC** 126.46 **ST** 111.89 **ESM** 69.93 **OH** 113.10 **HH** 64.79 **VH** 102.97 **Other PwD** 45.74

Cut-offs apply to marks normalised across all the exam's shifts, so a raw score on one shift is a rough guide. Source: the official result write-up, https://ssc.gov.in/api/attachment/uploads/masterData/NoticeBoards/Result%20Write-up%20CGLE%202024%20Tier%20I_51224.pdf

General Intelligence and Reasoning 18 questions

Q.1

Which of the following numbers will replace the question marks (?) in the given series? 16, 36, 64, ?, ?, 196, 256, 324

(A) 81, 100
(B) 81, 121
(C) 100, 121
(D) 100, 144

Q.2

Two sets of numbers are given below. In each set of numbers, certain mathematical operation(s) on the first number result(s) in the second number. Similarly, certain mathematical operation(s) on the second number result(s) in the third number and so on. Which of the given options follows the same set of operations as in the given sets? (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into their constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding/subtracting/multiplying to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.) 10 – 12 – 8 – 15; 12 – 14 – 10 – 19

(A) 8 – 6 – 10 – 18
(B) 11 – 13 – 9 – 17
(C) 6 – 8 – 12 – 16
(D) 15 – 13 – 9 – 19

Q.4

Based on the English alphabetical order, three of the following four letter-clusters are alike in a certain way and thus form a group. Which is the letter-cluster that DOES NOT belong to that group? (Note: The odd man out is not based on the number of consonants/vowels or their position in the letter-cluster.)

(A) DGK
(B) HKO
(C) ACG
(D) MPT

Q.5

Select the set in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following set. (11, 16.5, 22) (14.5, 20, 25.5) (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding/deleting/multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.)

(A) (14, 18.5, 23.5)
(B) (21.5, 25, 31.5)
(C) (24.5, 30, 36.5)
(D) (18, 23.5, 29)

Q.7

Which of the following terms will replace the question mark (?) in the given series? HPL, KLQ, NHV, QDA, TZF, ?

(A) WVK
(B) XVK
(C) WDK
(D) XWK

Q.8

In a certain code language, A + B means 'A is the son of B', A – B means 'A is the wife of B', A × B means 'A is the brother of B' and A ÷ B means 'A is the daughter of B'. Based on the above, how is P related to R if 'P × S ÷ M – T + R'?

(A) Daughter
(B) Brother
(C) Father's mother
(D) Son's son

Q.9

Three statements are given followed by three conclusions numbered I, II and III. Assuming the statements to be true, even if they seem to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: All cards are postcards. Some postcards are books. All books are novels. Conclusions: I. Some postcards are novels. II. No card is a book. III. All cards are novels.

(A) Only II and III conclusion follow
(B) Only I and II conclusion follow
(C) Only conclusion I follows
(D) Only conclusion III follows

Q.11

'NGRP' is related to 'JCNL' in a certain way based on the English alphabetical order. In the same way, 'FKLT' is related to 'BGHP'. To which of the following is 'SQUO' related, following the same logic?

(A) PNRL
(B) PMRK
(C) ONQL
(D) OMQK

Q.12

Three of the following numbers are alike in a certain way and one is different. Pick the odd one out. (NOTE : Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding /deleting /multiplying etc., to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.)

(A) 12 – 7 – 209
(B) 19 – 11 – 330
(C) 23 – 8 – 343
(D) 15 – 9 – 264

Q.13

Which of the following operations should be interchanged to make the following equation correct? 12 + 12 – 4 × 4 ÷ 2 = 22

(A) – and +
(B) + and ÷
(C) ÷ and –
(D) × and –

Q.14

Select the combination of letters that when sequentially placed in the blanks of the given series will complete the series. E_GHEI_GELK_ _OME

(A) IFGE
(B) IGFE
(C) FIFE
(D) FGEI

Q.15

In a certain code language, 'talk to me' is coded as 'aq yt bl' and 'do not talk' is coded as 'yt me wc'. What is the code for 'talk' in that language?

(A) aq
(B) wc
(C) yt
(D) bl

Q.16

What will come in place of the question mark (?) in the following equation if '+' and '–' are interchanged and '×' and '÷' are interchanged? 16 ÷ 4 + 8 × 8 – 4 = ?

(A) 67
(B) 42
(C) 11
(D) 36

Q.18

346 is related to 245 by certain logic. Following the same logic, 580 is related to 479. To which of the following is 613 related, following the same logic? (NOTE : Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding /deleting /multiplying etc., to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.)

(A) 512
(B) 460
(C) 720
(D) 630

Q.20

Select the word-pair that best represents a similar relationship to the one expressed in the pair of words given below. (The words must be considered as meaningful English words and must NOT be related to each other based on the number of letters/number of consonants/vowels in the word) Duleep Trophy : Cricket

(A) Burdwan Trophy : Polo
(B) Agha Khan Cup : Hockey
(C) Dhyan Chand Trophy : Badminton
(D) Durand Cup : Cricket

Q.21

Each vowel in the word 'STAMINA' is changed to the preceding letter in the English alphabetical order and each consonant is changed to the following letter in the English alphabetical order. How many letters are there in the English alphabetical order between the letter which is the third from the right and the fourth from the left in the group of letters thus formed?

(A) Four
(B) Six
(C) Seven
(D) Five

Q.22

In a certain code language, 'can we play' is coded as 'ae tc nx' and 'play in school' is coded as 'tc rm ef'. How is 'play' coded in that language?

(A) ae
(B) rm
(C) ef
(D) tc

Q.23

In a certain code language, 'BOOK' is written as 'ZNNI' and 'SHOP' is written as 'QFNN'. How will 'NOTES' be written in that language?

(A) LNRDQ
(B) LRDQN
(C) LDNQR
(D) QDRNL

General Awareness 24 questions

Q.1

Chand Bardai's famous literary work _____, mentions Prithviraj Chauhan's love story and heroic deeds.

(A) Rajamartanda
(B) Harakeli Nataka
(C) Prithviraj Raso
(D) Abhidhana Chintamani

Q.2

Who established Shantiniketan and when?

(A) Ravindranath Tagore, 1905
(B) Mahatma Gandhi, 1910
(C) Ravindranath Tagore, 1901
(D) Devendranath Tagore, 1915

Q.3

In which year was the Digital India mission launched?

(A) 2017
(B) 2015
(C) 2014
(D) 2016

Q.4

In July 2020, which state initiated the 'Ashirwad Scheme' to extend financial support for a daughter's marriage who belongs to a family earning a lower income?

(A) Rajasthan
(B) Bihar
(C) Uttar Pradesh
(D) Punjab

Q.5

Hindustani singer Pandit Venkatesh Kumar was honoured with 'Kalidas Samman-2022' by which state government?

(A) Maharashtra
(B) Madhya Pradesh
(C) Gujarat
(D) Uttar Pradesh

Q.6

Which of the following institutes was founded by Mrinalini Sarabhai who was a Bharatanatyam and Kathakali dancer?

(A) Nalanda Nritya Kala Mahavidyalaya
(B) Nrityanjali Institute of Performing Arts
(C) Sri Thyagaraja College of Music and Dance
(D) Darpana Academy of Performing Arts

Q.8

Which of the following hills is located in the Eastern Ghats?

(A) Shevaroy hills
(B) Khasi hills
(C) Anamudi hills
(D) Naga hills

Q.9

Who among the following players is related to table tennis?

(A) Pankaj Advani
(B) Manika Batra
(C) K Srikanth
(D) Manish Narwal

Q.10

What are the five Fs of indirect transmission?

(A) Fruit, fingers, flu, food and fluid
(B) Flies, fingers, fomites, food and fluid
(C) Flies, fingers, friends, food and fruit
(D) Flies, fingers, fomites, food and fruit

Q.11

Which of the following is an example of public sector industry in India?

(A) Tata Iron Steel Company
(B) Bajaj Auto
(C) Dabur
(D) Bharat Heavy Electricals Limited

Q.12

The Election Laws Amendment Bill passed in the Parliament recently seeks to implement certain electoral reforms. One of them is the eligibility date. Till now, only one date – 1 January was considered for deciding eligibility with respect to age. What reform does the Bill seek in this regard?

(A) Eliminating the idea of eligibility date – enrolment throughout the year
(B) Introducing three dates – 1 January, 1 May, 1 September
(C) Introducing four dates – 1 January, 1 April, 1 July, 1 October
(D) Introducing two dates – 1 January and 1 June

Q.13

Which of the following is NOT a Fundamental Duty of the Indian citizens?

(A) To cherish and follow the noble ideas that inspired our national struggle for freedom.
(B) Mandatory national service of 5 years.
(C) To develop scientific temper, humanism and the spirit of inquiry and reform.
(D) To safeguard public property and to abjure violence.

Q.14

_____ leaves are used to make bidis.

(A) Neem
(B) Betel
(C) Tendu
(D) Champa

Q.15

Buddhadev Dasgupta is famous for playing which of the following musical instruments?

(A) Sarangi
(B) Sarod
(C) Bansuri
(D) Mridangam

Q.16

In which of the following years was Pro Kabaddi League established in India?

(A) 2016
(B) 2015
(C) 2014
(D) 2013

Q.17

According to Census of India 2011, what is the gap between male and female literacy rate in India?

(A) 21.59%
(B) 24.84%
(C) 16.68%
(D) 18.30%

Q.18

In which form of exchange are goods used as medium of exchange?

(A) Barter exchange
(B) Currency exchange
(C) Credit exchange
(D) Online exchange

Q.19

What is the product formed when zinc and sulphuric acid react?

(A) Zinc oxide
(B) Zinc sulphide
(C) Zinc sulphate
(D) Zinc hydroxide

Q.20

In the state legislative assembly, the Money bill can be introduced with the prior permission of _____.

(A) Auditor General
(B) Finance Minister
(C) Governor
(D) CAG

Q.21

Which of the following gases emits red light when electricity is passed through it?

(A) Argon
(B) Neon
(C) Hydrogen
(D) Helium

Q.22

The Vedangas are Hindu auxiliary disciplines that originated in ancient times and are linked to the study of the Vedas. These are _____ in number.

(A) seven
(B) five
(C) six
(D) four

Q.23

Gangaur Festival, Pushkar Fair, Nagaur Fair and Urs Fair are the popular fairs and festivals of which state?

(A) Maharashtra
(B) Tripura
(C) Rajasthan
(D) Punjab

Q.24

Who among the following freedom fighters is known as 'Deshbandhu'?

(A) Gopal Krishna Gokhale
(B) Chittaranjan Das
(C) Subhas Chandra Bose
(D) Bhagat Singh

Q.25

What was the actual growth rate of the first five-year plan?

(A) 4.2%
(B) 2.6%
(C) 3.6%
(D) 2.1%

Quantitative Aptitude 14 questions

Q.1

The average of the squares of the first 46 natural numbers is

(A) 730.5
(B) 727.5
(C) 729.5
(D) 728.5

Q.3

The MP of an article was Rs.180 and it was sold at a discount of 15%, the discount in Rs. is:

(A) 27
(B) 15
(C) 12
(D) 18

Q.4

In ΔDEF, the bisector of ∠D intersects side EF at point N. If DE = 36 cm, DF = 40 cm and EF = 38 cm, then the length (in cm) of NF is _____.

(A) 18 **(B)** 20

(C) 12 **(D)** 16

Q.5

Find the area of a sector with an arc length of 44 cm, which subtends a central angle of 30°.

(A) 1584 cm^2 **(B)** 1488 cm^2

(C) 1884 cm^2 **(D)** 1848 cm^2

Q.11

A thief pursued by a policeman was 150 m ahead at the start. If the ratio of the speed of the policeman to that of the thief was 5 : 4, then how far (distance in metres) could the thief go before he is caught by the policeman?

(A) 200 **(B)** 600

(C) 400 **(D)** 350

Q.12

The ratio between male and female members in a club is 2 : 3. If the number of male members is increased by 200, the ratio becomes 5 : 6. How many female members are there in the club?

(A) 1400 **(B)** 1000

(C) 1200 **(D)** 900

Q.14

Two pipes A and B can fill a tank in 48 minutes and 66 minutes, respectively. If both the pipes are opened simultaneously, then after how many minutes should pipe B be closed so that the tank gets filled in 32 minutes?

(A) 22 **(B)** 20

(C) 16 **(D)** 18

Q.16

Every month, a man consumes 20 kg of rice and 8 kg of wheat. The price of rice is 20% of the price of wheat, resulting in a total expenditure of ₹300 per month for rice and wheat combined. If the price of wheat is increased by 20%, what percentage reduction in rice consumption is needed to maintain the same expenditure of ₹300? (Given that price of rice and consumption of wheat is constant.)

(A) 24% **(B)** 22%

(C) 40% **(D)** 38%

Q.17

In triangle ABC, the length of side BC is 2 cm less than twice the length of side AB. The length of side AC exceeds the length of side AB by 10 cm. The perimeter of the triangle is 40 cm. Determine the length (in cm) of the smallest side of the triangle.

(A) 12 **(B)** 10

(C) 14 **(D)** 8

Q.18

From a point T, the length of the tangent to a circle is 32 cm and the distance of T from the centre is 40 cm. The diameter (in cm) of the circle is:

(A) 48 **(B)** 16

(C) 32 **(D)** 36

Q.19

Two cylinders have the radii of their bases in the ratio 4 : 5 and their heights are in the ratio 5 : 7. Find the ratio of their curved surface areas.

(A) 5 : 4
(B) 4 : 5
(C) 1 : 2
(D) 4 : 7

Q.20

In a garden, there are 6 daisy plants the first year. Each year, a gardener adds 3 new daisy plants. He has 26 jasmine plants the first year and loses 2 each year. When will the number of daisy plants equal to the number of jasmine plants after the first year?

(A) 6 years
(B) 4 years
(C) 5 years
(D) 2 years

Q.21

Which of following numbers is NOT divisible by 11?

(A) 109153
(B) 5445
(C) 80124
(D) 128041

Q.25

For the following equations, what are the values of a and b to have infinitely many solutions? ax + by = 2; 3x - (5 - 2a)y = 6

(A) a = 1,b = - 1
(B) a = - 1,b = - 1
(C) a = - 1,b = 1
(D) a = 1,b = 1

English Comprehension 24 questions

Q.1

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blanks. He had _____ the _____ into smaller clips.

(A) clipping, clips
(B) clips, clipping
(C) clipped, clipping
(D) clipping, clipped

Q.2

Select the sentence that does NOT have a spelling error.

(A) The focus of the exibition is to reinforce versatility and creative thinking.
(B) The insouciance of the rock star considering the importance of the occasion, came as a shock to the audience who expected stressful moments.
(C) The artist received recognition for her impressive etchings, buclic landscapes, and recreation of natural scenes around her.
(D) The paintings are structured chronologically, starting from cubism to surealism.

Q.3

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. My sisters “wished me good luck” before I went on the stage to sing.

(A) Told me to break an arm
(B) Told me to break the ice
(C) Told me to sit on the fence
(D) Told me to break a leg

Q.4

Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice. The drug pedlar was arrested by the narcotics team.

(A) The narcotics team arrest the drug pedlar.
(B) The narcotics team has arrested the drug pedlar.
(C) The narcotics team was arrested the drug pedlar.
(D) The narcotics team arrested the drug pedlar.

Q.6

Select the most appropriate synonym of the underlined word. Many people love to visit “enchanting” hills.

(A) risky
(B) alluring
(C) echoing
(D) cool

Q.7

Parts of a sentence are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the parts in the correct order to form a meaningful sentence. A. needs to be B. the shelf in C. a piece of wood D. the kitchen E. need to buy F. replaced, so I will

(A) BDAFEC
(B) ACDBFE
(C) DEBACF
(D) BEFCAD

Q.8

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. The list of subjects to be discussed at a meeting

(A) Agenda
(B) Menu
(C) Minutes
(D) Objectives

Q.9

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the word in brackets to fill in the blank. She has _____ (witty) remarks about everything.

(A) whimsical
(B) unamusing
(C) woeful
(D) sorry

Q.10

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Paralysed

(A) Demure
(B) Healthy
(C) Stifled
(D) Sultry

Q.11

The following sentence has been divided into four segments. Identify the segment that contains an adverbial usage error. Mr. Arun / will pay dear / for his / financial mistake.

(A) Mr. Arun
(B) financial mistake
(C) for his
(D) will pay dear

Q.12

Select the most appropriate synonym of the word in brackets to fill in the blank. Listening to the same lecture everyday appeared very _____ to him. (boring)

(A) monotonous
(B) furious
(C) monolithic
(D) nervous

Q.13
Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. We have postponed this movie outing too many times, so we are going tomorrow, come _____ or shine.

(A) hail
(B) rain
(C) mountain
(D) thunder

Q.14
Parts of a sentence are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the parts in the correct order to form a meaningful sentence. O. went P. yesterday Q. we R. to the S. park

(A) QORSP
(B) PSROQ
(C) RQOSP
(D) OPQRS

Q.15
Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Repulse

(A) Substitute
(B) Recover
(C) Reprove
(D) Repel

Q.16
Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word in the given sentence. One must be confident of winning and gaining one's goals and must face situations, disasters, trials and setbecks of life with confidence.

(A) Setbecks
(B) Trials
(C) Disasters
(D) Confident

Q.17
Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. Five years later, I "was eating" this same dish at the same restaurant.

(A) had been eating
(B) am eating
(C) has been eating
(D) will have be eating

Q.18
Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice. Scientists were conducting experiments on the newly discovered species.

(A) The newly discovered species has been conducting experiments by scientists.
(B) Experiments were being conducted on the newly discovered species by scientists.
(C) The newly discovered species has been experimented on by scientists.
(D) Experiments on the newly discovered species had been conducted by the scientists.

Q.19
Parts of a sentence are given below in jumbled order. Select the option that arranges the parts in the correct sequence to form a meaningful sentence. (P) the sun (Q) to our planet, Earth (O) provides essential energy (R) sustaining life and warmth

(A) QROP
(B) POQR
(C) ROQP
(D) ORPQ

Q.20
The given sentence is divided into four segments. Select the option that has the segment with a grammatical error. The employees were comfortable / with me and they talked about / their problems since / I has worked there as a manager.

(A) with me and they talked about
(B) I has worked there as a manager.
(C) their problems since
(D) The employees were comfortable

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. People often say that the stars govern their fate but they forget the fact that success or failure is the result of one's own (1)_____. If we sow chaff, we can't reap grain; and the result or consequence of an action depends on what one does and to the extent he (2)_____ it. If we work hard, we succeed only to the extent that we work. People who think that the law of karma is (3)_____ may feel that if one is destined to get something he will always get it whether he strives for it or not. But experience tells us that reward and punishments are the direct result of our action. Honesty and hard work never go unrewarded and (4)_____ and evil deeds never go (5)_____. In fact even the law of karma, in its proper sense, means that the fruit we get is decided by whatever actions we did in the past.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) incidents
(B) case
(C) power
(D) actions

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. People often say that the stars govern their fate but they forget the fact that success or failure is the result of one's own (1)_____. If we sow chaff, we can't reap grain; and the result or consequence of an action depends on what one does and to the extent he (2)_____ it. If we work hard, we succeed only to the extent that we work. People who think that the law of karma is (3)_____ may feel that if one is destined to get something he will always get it whether he strives for it or not. But experience tells us that reward and punishments are the direct result of our action. Honesty and hard work never go unrewarded and (4)_____ and evil deeds never go (5)_____. In fact even the law of karma, in its proper sense, means that the fruit we get is decided by whatever actions we did in the past.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) does
(B) have
(C) put
(D) create

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. People often say that the stars govern their fate but they forget the fact that success or failure is the result of one's own (1)_____. If we sow chaff, we can't reap grain; and the result or consequence of an action depends on what one does and to the extent he (2)_____ it. If we work hard, we succeed only to the extent that we work. People who think that the law of karma is (3)_____ may feel that if one is destined to get something he will always get it whether he strives for it or not. But experience tells us that reward and punishments are the direct result of our action. Honesty and hard work never go unrewarded and (4)_____ and evil deeds never go (5)_____. In fact even the law of karma, in its proper sense, means that the fruit we get is decided by whatever actions we did in the past.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) supreme
(B) most
(C) more
(D) greatest

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. People often say that the stars govern their fate but they forget the fact that success or failure is the result of one's own (1)_____. If we sow chaff, we can't reap grain; and the result or consequence of an action depends on what one does and to the extent he (2)_____ it. If we work hard, we succeed only to the extent that we work. People who think that the law of karma is (3)_____ may feel that if one is destined to get something he will always get it whether he strives for it or not. But experience tells us that reward and punishments are the direct result of our action. Honesty and hard work never go unrewarded and (4)_____ and evil deeds never go (5)_____. In fact even the law of karma, in its proper sense, means that the fruit we get is decided by whatever actions we did in the past.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) horribly

(B) fairness

(C) badly

(D) dishonesty

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. People often say that the stars govern their fate but they forget the fact that success or failure is the result of one's own (1)_____. If we sow chaff, we can't reap grain; and the result or consequence of an action depends on what one does and to the extent he (2)_____ it. If we work hard, we succeed only to the extent that we work. People who think that the law of karma is (3)_____ may feel that if one is destined to get something he will always get it whether he strives for it or not. But experience tells us that reward and punishments are the direct result of our action. Honesty and hard work never go unrewarded and (4)_____ and evil deeds never go (5)_____. In fact even the law of karma, in its proper sense, means that the fruit we get is decided by whatever actions we did in the past.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) vile

(B) unpunished

(C) waste

(D) punished

Answer key

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(D)**
Q.9 **(C)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(C)**	Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(C)**	Q.15 **(C)**
Q.16 **(A)**	Q.18 **(A)**	Q.20 **(B)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(A)**

General Awareness

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(D)**
Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(B)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(C)**	Q.13 **(B)**
Q.14 **(C)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(A)**	Q.19 **(C)**
Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(B)**	Q.25 **(C)**

Quantitative Aptitude

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(C)**
Q.14 **(A)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(A)**	Q.19 **(D)**	Q.20 **(B)**
Q.21 **(D)**	Q.25 **(A)**				

English Comprehension

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.6 **(B)**	Q.7 **(A)**
Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(B)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(A)**	Q.13 **(B)**
Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(B)**	Q.19 **(B)**
Q.20 **(B)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(A)**	Q.24 **(D)**	Q.25 **(B)**

Explanations

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 · Answer (D) 100, 144

The terms are the squares of the even numbers: 4^2, 6^2, 8^2, 10^2, 12^2, 14^2, 16^2, 18^2. The missing terms are 100 and 144.

Q.2 · Answer (B) 11 – 13 – 9 – 17

In each set: add 2, subtract 4, then double and subtract 1: 10 → 12 → 8 → 15 and 12 → 14 → 10 → 19. Likewise 11 → 13 → 9 → 17.

Q.4 · Answer (C) ACG

In DGK, HKO and MPT the letters move +3, then +4. ACG moves +2, then +4, so it is the odd one.

Q.5 · Answer (D) (18, 23.5, 29)

Each number is 5.5 more than the one before it: 11, 16.5, 22 and 14.5, 20, 25.5. Likewise 18, 23.5, 29.

Q.7 · Answer (A) WVK

First letters move +3 (H, K, N, Q, T, so next W); second letters –4 (P, L, H, D, Z, so V); third letters +5 (L, Q, V, A, F, so K): WVK.

Q.8 · Answer (D) Son's son

T + R: T is R's son. M – T: M is T's wife. S ÷ M: S is M's daughter, and so T's. P × S: P is S's brother, so T's son. P is R's son's son.

Q.9 · Answer (C) Only conclusion I follows

The postcards that are books are novels, so some postcards are novels (I). Nothing says whether any card is a book or a novel, so neither II nor III follows.

Q.11 · Answer (D) OMQK

Each letter moves 4 places back: N → J, G → C, R → N, P → L and F → B, K → G, L → H, T → P. So SQUO → OMQK.

Q.12 · Answer (C) 23 – 8 – 343

In 12 – 7 – 209, 19 – 11 – 330 and 15 – 9 – 264 the third number is 11 times the sum of the first two (19 × 11, 30 × 11, 24 × 11). For 23 – 8 that would be 31 × 11 = 341, not 343.

Q.13 · Answer (C) ÷ and –

Interchanging ÷ and –: 12 + 12 ÷ 4 × 4 – 2 = 12 + 12 – 2 = 22.

Q.14 · Answer (C) FIFE

With F, I, F, E in the blanks the series reads EFGH EIIG ELKF EOME: each block starts with E, the second letters move +3 (F, I, L, O), the third +2 (G, I, K, M) and the fourth –1 (H, G, F, E).

Q.15 · Answer (C) yt

'talk' is the only word in both sentences and 'yt' the only code in both, so talk = yt.

Q.16 · Answer (A) 67

After interchanging the signs: 16 × 4 – 8 ÷ 8 + 4 = 64 – 1 + 4 = 67.

Q.18 · Answer (A) 512

The second number is 101 less than the first: 346 – 101 = 245 and 580 – 101 = 479. Likewise 613 – 101 = 512.

Q.20 · Answer (B) Agha Khan Cup : Hockey

The Duleep Trophy is a cricket tournament, as the Agha Khan Cup is a hockey tournament. The Durand Cup is a football tournament, not a cricket one.

Q.21 · Answer (D) Five

STAMINA becomes T U Z N H O Z. The third letter from the right is H and the fourth from the left is N; between them come I, J, K, L and M: five letters.

Q.22 · Answer (D) tc
'play' is the only word in both sentences and 'tc' the only code in both, so play = tc.

Q.23 · Answer (A) LNRDQ
Consonants move 2 places back and vowels 1: BOOK → ZNNI and SHOP → QFNN. So NOTES → LNRDQ.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (C) Prithviraj Raso
Chand Bardai, the court poet of Prithviraj Chauhan, wrote the 'Prithviraj Raso', an epic of the king's life, love and battles.

Q.2 · Answer (C) Ravindranath Tagore, 1901
Rabindranath Tagore started his school at Santiniketan in 1901; it grew into Visva-Bharati University in 1921. The ashram there had been set up by his father, Debendranath Tagore, in 1863, not 1915.

Q.3 · Answer (B) 2015
The Digital India programme was launched on 1 July 2015.

Q.4 · Answer (D) Punjab
SSC's key gives Punjab, which runs the Ashirwad Scheme for the marriage of daughters of low-income families.

Q.5 · Answer (B) Madhya Pradesh
SSC's key gives Madhya Pradesh, whose government confers the Kalidas Samman, a national award for the arts that includes music.

Q.6 · Answer (D) Darpana Academy of Performing Arts
Mrinalini Sarabhai founded the Darpana Academy of Performing Arts in Ahmedabad in 1949.

Q.8 · Answer (A) Shevaroy hills
The Shevaroy hills, around Yercaud in Tamil Nadu, are part of the Eastern Ghats. Anamudi is in the Western Ghats, and the Khasi and Naga hills are in the north-east.

Q.9 · Answer (B) Manika Batra
Manika Batra is a table tennis player. Pankaj Advani plays billiards and snooker, K Srikanth badminton, and Manish Narwal is a para shooter.

Q.10 · Answer (B) Flies, fingers, fomites, food and fluid
Faeco-oral infections spread indirectly through flies, fingers, fomites (contaminated objects), food and fluid (water).

Q.11 · Answer (D) Bharat Heavy Electricals Limited
Bharat Heavy Electricals Limited is owned by the Government of India; Tata Steel, Bajaj Auto and Dabur are private companies.

Q.12 · Answer (C) Introducing four dates – 1 January, 1 April, 1 July, 1 October
The Election Laws (Amendment) Act, 2021 gives four qualifying dates a year for enrolment: 1 January, 1 April, 1 July and 1 October.

Q.13 · Answer (B) Mandatory national service of 5 years.
Article 51A has no compulsory national service; it asks citizens to defend the country and render national service when called upon to do so. The other three are Fundamental Duties.

Q.14 · Answer (C) Tendu
Bidis are rolled in the leaves of the tendu tree (Diospyros melanoxylon), a minor forest produce of central India.

Q.15 · Answer (B) Sarod
Pandit Buddhadev Das Gupta was a leading sarod player.

Q.16 · Answer (C) 2014
The Pro Kabaddi League began in 2014.

Q.17 · Answer (C) 16.68%
Census 2011 put male literacy at 82.14% and female literacy at 65.46%: a gap of 16.68 percentage points.

Q.18 · Answer (A) Barter exchange
In barter, goods are exchanged directly for other goods, without money.

Q.19 · Answer (C) Zinc sulphate
Zinc displaces hydrogen from dilute sulphuric acid: $Zn + H_2SO_4 \rightarrow ZnSO_4 + H_2$.

Q.20 · Answer (C) Governor
Under Article 207 a Money Bill can be introduced in a state legislature only on the recommendation of the Governor, and only in the Legislative Assembly.

Q.21 · Answer (B) Neon
Neon glows red-orange when a current passes through it, as in neon signs.

Q.22 · Answer (C) six
The six Vedangas are Shiksha (phonetics), Kalpa (ritual), Vyakarana (grammar), Nirukta (etymology), Chhandas (metre) and Jyotisha (astronomy).

Q.23 · Answer (C) Rajasthan
Gangaur, the Pushkar and Nagaur fairs and the Urs at Ajmer are all held in Rajasthan.

Q.24 · Answer (B) Chittaranjan Das
Chittaranjan Das was called 'Deshbandhu', friend of the nation.

Q.25 · Answer (C) 3.6%
The First Five-Year Plan (1951-56) aimed at 2.1% annual growth and achieved about 3.6%.

Quantitative Aptitude

Q.1 · Answer (D) 728.5
The sum of the squares of 1 to n is $n(n + 1)(2n + 1)/6$, so their average is $(n + 1)(2n + 1)/6 = 47 \times 93/6 = 4371/6 = 728.5$.

Q.3 · Answer (A) 27
15% of ₹180 = ₹27.

Q.4 · Answer (B) 20
The bisector of $\angle D$ divides EF in the ratio DE : DF = 36 : 40 = 9 : 10, so NF = $38 \times 10/19 = 20$ cm.

Q.5 · Answer (D) 1848 cm²
Arc length = $(30/360) \times 2\pi r = \pi r/6 = 44$, so r = 84 cm ($\pi = 22/7$). Area = ½ × arc length × radius = ½ × 44 × 84 = 1848 cm².

Q.11 · Answer (B) 600
In the time the policeman runs 5 m the thief runs 4 m, so the policeman gains 1 m. To make up 150 m, the thief runs $150 \times 4 = 600$ m.

Q.12 · Answer (C) 1200
Let there be 2x men and 3x women. $(2x + 200) : 3x = 5 : 6$ gives $12x + 1200 = 15x$, so x = 400 and there are 1200 female members.

Q.14 · Answer (A) 22
In 32 minutes A fills 32/48 = 2/3 of the tank, so B must fill the other 1/3: 66/3 = 22 minutes.

Q.16 · Answer (C) 40%
With wheat at ₹w a kg and rice at 0.2w: $20 \times 0.2w + 8w = 12w = 300$, so wheat costs ₹25 and rice ₹5. At ₹30, 8 kg of wheat costs ₹240, leaving ₹60 for 12 kg of rice instead of 20: a cut of 8/20 = 40%.

Q.17 · Answer (D) 8
With AB = x: BC = 2x – 2 and AC = x + 10, so 4x + 8 = 40 and x = 8. The sides are 8, 14 and 18 cm.

Q.18 · Answer (A) 48
The radius is perpendicular to the tangent: $r = \sqrt{(40^2 - 32^2)} = \sqrt{576} = 24$ cm, so the diameter is 48 cm.

Q.19 · Answer (D) 4 : 7
Curved surface area = $2\pi rh$, so the ratio is $(4 \times 5) : (5 \times 7) = 20 : 35 = 4 : 7$.

Q.20 · Answer (B) 4 years
After k more years there are 6 + 3k daisy plants and 26 – 2k jasmine plants. 6 + 3k = 26 – 2k gives k = 4: 18 of each.

Q.21 · Answer (D) 128041
A number is divisible by 11 when its alternate digit sums differ by a multiple of 11. For 128041: (1 + 0 + 2) – (4 + 8 + 1) = –10. The others give –11 (109153), 0 (5445) and 11 (80124).

Q.25 · Answer (A) a = 1,b = - 1
Infinitely many solutions need a/3 = b/(–(5 – 2a)) = 2/6. So a = 1, and b = –(5 – 2)/3 = –1.

English Comprehension

Q.1 · Answer (C) clipped, clipping
'Had' takes the past participle 'clipped'; the object is a noun, 'clipping' (a piece cut from a film or recording).

Q.2 · Answer (B) The insouciance of the rock star considering the importance of the occasion, came as a shock to the audience who expected stressful moments.
The other sentences misspell 'exhibition', 'bucolic' and 'surrealism'.

Q.3 · Answer (D) Told me to break a leg
'Break a leg' is said to a performer before going on stage, to wish them good luck.

Q.4 · Answer (D) The narcotics team arrested the drug pedlar.
'Was arrested by' is simple past passive, so the active is simple past: 'The narcotics team arrested the drug pedlar.'

Q.6 · Answer (B) alluring
'Enchanting' means delightfully charming: 'alluring'.

Q.7 · Answer (A) BDAFEC
'The shelf in (B) the kitchen (D) needs to be (A) replaced, so I will (F) need to buy (E) a piece of wood (C).'

Q.8 · Answer (A) Agenda
An agenda is the list of items to be discussed at a meeting; the minutes record what was said.

Q.9 · Answer (B) unamusing
'Witty' means cleverly amusing; its opposite is 'unamusing'.

Q.10 · Answer (B) Healthy
'Paralysed' means unable to move through illness or injury. Of the options only 'healthy' points the other way; 'stifled' is close in meaning.

Q.11 · Answer (D) will pay dear
With 'pay' the adverb should be 'dearly': 'Mr. Arun will pay dearly for his financial mistake.'

Q.12 · Answer (A) monotonous
'Monotonous' means dull through sameness: boring.

Q.13 · Answer (B) rain
'Come rain or shine' means whatever happens.

Q.14 · Answer (A) QORSP
'We went to the park yesterday': QORSP.

Q.15 · Answer (D) Repel
To 'repulse' is to drive back: to 'repel'.

Q.16 · Answer (A) Setbecks
The correct spelling is 'setbacks'.

Q.17 · Answer (B) am eating
SSC's key picks 'am eating': five years on, the speaker is eating the same dish now. 'Was eating' also reads correctly as a past narrative, but there is no 'no substitution' option; 'has been eating' does not agree with 'I', and 'will have be eating' is ungrammatical.

Q.18 · Answer (B) Experiments were being conducted on the newly discovered species by scientists.
The past continuous 'were conducting' becomes 'were being conducted' in the passive.

Q.19 · Answer (B) POQR
'The sun (P) provides essential energy (O) to our planet, Earth (Q) sustaining life and warmth (R).'

Q.20 · Answer (B) I has worked there as a manager.
'I' does not take 'has'; in this past-tense sentence it should be 'since I had worked there as a manager'.

Q.21 · Answer (D) actions
Success or failure is the result of one's own 'actions'; the passage later calls rewards and punishments 'the direct result of our action'.

Q.22 · Answer (A) does
'To the extent he does it' picks up 'what one does' earlier in the sentence.

Q.23 · Answer (A) supreme
Those who think the law of karma is 'supreme', all-powerful, believe fate decides everything; 'most', 'more' and 'greatest' do not fit without 'the' or a comparison.

Q.24 · Answer (D) dishonesty
The blank needs a noun to pair with 'evil deeds', as 'honesty' pairs with 'hard work': 'dishonesty'.

Q.25 · Answer (B) unpunished
Evil deeds never go 'unpunished', just as honesty never goes unrewarded.

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